

The Last Spell- Official modding guide

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Mods in The Last Spell

What can be modded in The Last Spell?

For the moment, you can add your own **localizations** and **fonts** in The Last Spell. However, we're very hopeful that will change in the future!

How do I subscribe to a mod?

If you want to subscribe to a Steam mod, you need to go to the Workshop Hub of the game:

<https://steamcommunity.com/app/1105670/workshop/>

And then click on "Browse" → Items

A list of mods should appear, and you just need to click on the one(s) you want and click "Subscribe" in the Page that opens.

The mod will automatically download after that.

Structure of a mod

A mod is usually made like this:

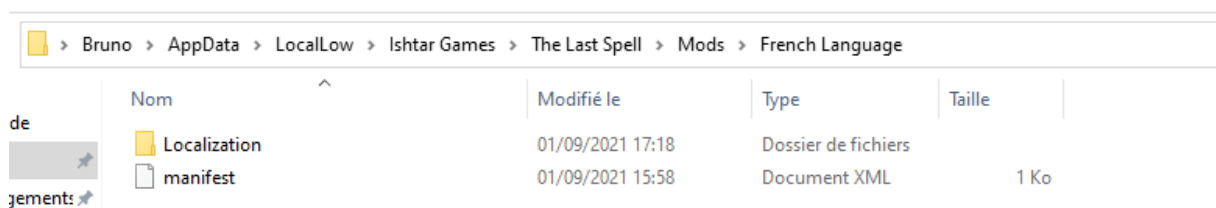
- Parent folder
 - o Manifest.xml
 - o Thumbnail
 - o Modules Folders
 - Files/Folders that are necessary for the proper functioning of the module (fonts; .csv, etc)

What are the "modules"?

⇒ The mods work with a "Module" architecture. A Mod can be a Translation Mod and/or a Fonts Mod.

How do you define a Module?

⇒ A module is defined by creating a subfolder of the *Parent Folder*. However, that folder must have a specific name, the name of the folder will allow us to know its *Type* (the available *Modules* names will be listed in their respective sections, further in the document). If the *Module* needs a configuration file, you'll need to create one in the *Module* folder (the content of this file depends on the type of the *Module*).



de				
jements: ✨				
Nom	Modifié le	Type	Taille	
Localization	01/09/2021 17:18	Dossier de fichiers		
manifest	01/09/2021 15:58	Document XML	1 Ko	

Create your own mod

Get the *Example Mod*

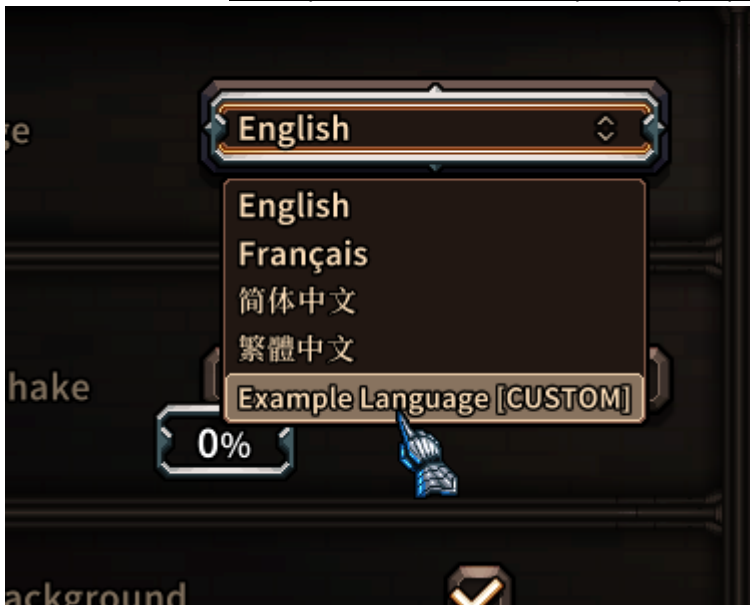
You don't *need* this example per se, but it will help with the mod structure creation as you will be able to copy this model.

You'll need to subscribe to this mod to download it, it can be found here:

<https://steamcommunity.com/sharedfiles/filedetails/?id=2607059231>

This mod gives a small example of both a Localization Module and a Fonts Module.

- Localization: it loads an entire new localization, but this file is mostly empty (so most of the labels will default to the standard English). To check that it works, you have to launch the game, go to options and then select the language "Example Language" and then go back to the main menu => the "Options" label will be replaced by "Options Test".



- Fonts: it replaces the 2 fonts of the game. You won't notice any difference on the "standard" font because it actually loads the same that is used without mod, but you will definitely notice that the title font has changed.

Local mod

Create the structure for your mod

This section will describe what needs to be done to create a mod, so that you know how it works, but you can actually ease the process by duplicating the Example Mod structure.

To do so, once downloaded you can find it in your steam files at this location

`SteamLibrary\steamapps\workshop\content\1105670\2607059231` and copy all the folder "2607059231" into `%Appdata%\..\LocalLow\Ishtar Games\The Last Spell\Mods\`, then rename the folder to your mod's name and delete the "steam_workshop.txt" (this removes the link with the original Steam Workshop mod).

Otherwise, you first need to create a “Mods” folder in this folder

%Appdata%\..\LocalLow\Ishtar Games\The Last Spell\. Then, inside this folder, you must create a folder with your mod in it (you can name the folder as you want)

Nom	Modifié le	Type	Taille
Logs	31/08/2021 14:57	Dossier de fichiers	
MetaStates	31/08/2021 13:59	Dossier de fichiers	
Mods	01/09/2021 17:17	Dossier de fichiers	
Save	31/08/2021 14:00	Dossier de fichiers	
output_log	31/08/2021 14:58	Document texte	23 Ko

runo > AppData > LocalLow > Ishtar Games > The Last Spell > Mods

Nom	Modifié le	Type	Taille
French Language	01/09/2021 17:17	Dossier de fichiers	

In your new mod folder, you need to have a file called “manifest.xml”, and at least one Module in a folder named accordingly (cf the respective Module sections later in this guide). If the mod folder doesn’t have those, then it won’t be considered a mod by the game.

Bruno > AppData > LocalLow > Ishtar Games > The Last Spell > Mods > French Language				
	Nom	Modifié le	Type	Taille
	Localization	01/09/2021 17:18	Dossier de fichiers	
	manifest	01/09/2021 15:58	Document XML	1 Ko

The “manifest.xml” file

This file allows us to know the title and the description of the mod. This will allow the mod to be correctly displayed in the interface that lists the currently installed/used by the game mods. That info will also be used when the mod goes online to name and describe the mod. If you put “true” after “OverrideSteamDatas”, that info will also be used when the creator of the mod will publish an update.

```
1 <Manifest OverrideSteamDatas="true">
2   <Title>PMU French Trad</Title>
3   <Description>Ce mod ajoute de nouvelles langues au jeu.</Description>
4   <Author>PMU</Author>
5   <Version>1</Version>
6 </Manifest>
```

- **OverrideSteamDatas** : This is used to know if you want to update the title and the description of the mod in the workshop when the creator will want to publish an update for the mod. It's not required, and if it's not declared, then it will be considered that the creator doesn't want to update the title and the description of the mod after an update.
- **Title** : *(Required)* This allows you to give a title to the mod when it's published in the workshop.
- **Description** : *(Optional)* This allows you to write a description to the mod when it's published in the workshop.
- **Author** : *(Optional)* This allows you to put the creator's name in the interface that lists the used mods.
- **Version**: *(introduced with the Version 2 of the Modding)* This will allow us to know the version that is targeted. We'll also have the "ModdingVersion" and the "ModdingMinVersion" that will allow us to know whether the Mod is considered as compatible or not. The modder will need to write the current version of the ModdingVersion during its creation, so after an update if the ModdingVersion and/or the ModdingMinVersion has changed, the game will be able to detect if the Mod is still compatible. With Version 3, you need to have at least "3" as the version number.

You can find the Modding Version here:



Once that's done, your mod is enabled ingame!

Check if the mod is active

When you launch the game, you should see a button in the upper left corner of your screen in the main menu.



The button will open a menu displaying the currently active mods ingame.

When you're subscribed to a mod on Steam, then you will automatically download the mods to which you're subscribed. If you're also the creator of this mod, then you'll technically have 2 version of the mod. So, one of those version (the Online one) will be greyed out, to prevent any bug or issue).

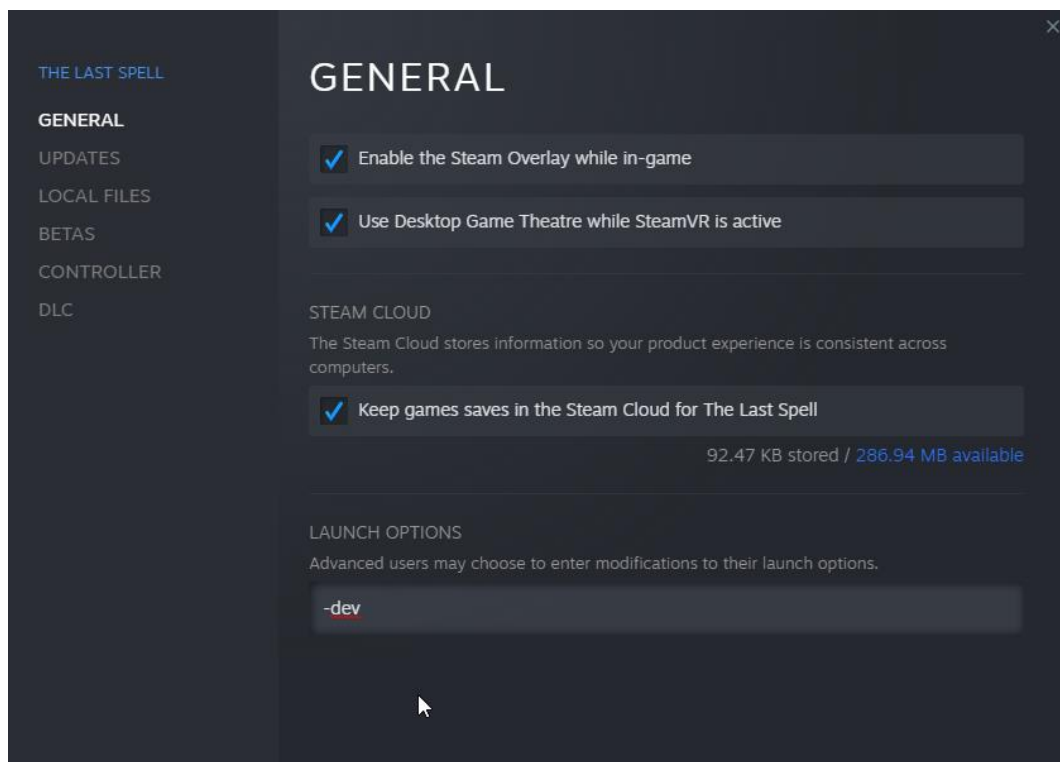
Steam Workshop

Publish a mod on the Steam Workshop

Once you have a working local mod and want to publish it to the Steam Workshop, you'll need to enable the "Developer" mode in the game.

In Steam, you need to right-click on "The Last Spell", "Settings", and a menu will open.

In the last line called "Launch Options", you're going to write the password to unlock the "Developer mode". The password is "-dev".



Once that's done, you need to launch The Last Spell, and go back to the "Mod" menu. Now, you should have a screen that looks like this.



You need to click on “Create in Workshop” to upload your mod in Steam.



Once that’s done, a file called “steam_workshop.txt” at the root of your local mod will be created. The file is actually a number representing the ID of the mod in the workshop. **Don’t modify or erase that file because you’ll need it to publish updates for your mod!**

Update a mod on the Steam Workshop

If you want to update a Steam mod, you’ll need to have the mod locally. So, you’ll need to have the steam_workshop.txt file in %Appdata%\..\LocalLow\Ishtar Games\The Last Spell\Mods\.

If you have the mod locally, and you’re in developer mode, the button in the menu will change and will be named “Update in Steam”



You need to be the creator of the mod to update it! Otherwise, it won’t work.

Uploading a thumbnail

If you want to create and upload a thumbnail so it's displayed on Steam, the image must:

- Be less than 1Mb
- Be one of the supported formats/extensions => .jpg, .png, .jpeg, or .gif
- Be named thumbnail.<extension>

Once your image is created, you need to place it in the mod folder, just like the manifest file.

We suggest making square images, because if it's not square, then it will be resized and may end up looking less good!

Mod Modules

Localization Module

The purpose of this Module is to bring new languages into the game.

Structure

The folder needed for this Module to work must be named *Localization* (cf section "Create the structure for your mod").

Inside of this folder will need to be the actual localization file, which is a .txt (its name doesn't matter) which content is under the form of a csv (comma separated values).



```
1 KEY, Japan,  
2 MainMenu_ContinueGameButton, 続ける - {0},  
3 MainMenu_ContinueCampaignButton, 継続 - キャンペーン,  
4 MainMenu_NewCampaignButton, 新キャンペーン,  
5 MainMenu_LoadGameButton, ゲームの読み込み,  
6 MainMenu_OptionsButton, オプション,
```

[Optional] The "config.xml" file to link a custom font

This file is **not mandatory** for the localization Module. For the moment, its only purpose is to link a language to a *FontAssembly* (cf. "Make a Font mod") to link a custom font to your localization.

Thus, this is only needed if you need/want to have a specific font with your localization and **requires creating a Font mod** beforehand.

The file must follow this pattern:

```
1  <Config>
2    <FontAssembliesBindings>
3      <LanguagesAndFontAssemblies>
4        <LanguageIds>Language ids separated by a comma</LanguageIds>
5        <FontAssemblyId>Font Assembly Id</FontAssemblyId>
6      </LanguagesAndFontAssemblies>
7    </FontAssembliesBindings>
8  </Config>
9
10 Example :
11
12 <Config>
13   <FontAssembliesBindings>
14     <LanguagesAndFontAssemblies>
15       These two languages are linked to the FontAssembly named : FontAssemblyOne
16       <LanguageIds>LanguageOne,LanguageTwo</LanguageIds>
17       <FontAssemblyId>FontAssemblyOne</FontAssemblyId>
18     </LanguagesAndFontAssemblies>
19   </FontAssembliesBindings>
20 </Config>
```

The *LanguagesAndFontAssemblies* can be repeated indefinitely. It will indicate to some languages that they're linked to a FontAssembly. It indicates a FontAssembly that it can be linked to several languages.

Translation

You can use any software you want, but we have setup a very streamlined process using GSheet with automatized updates/tracking as well as detailed guidelines, which is actually very close to our internal workflow, so that's the preferred method and the one we will focus on here.

The short summary is that it will allow you to:

- Translate all the ingame entries.
- Have some comments from the team when needed, providing additional context.
- Track the state of each entry, depending on your work and the modifications we perform on our end => New entries, Modified, Deleted, Done...
This is not continuous, you will receive those updates when we freeze a new file internally as "ready", most likely close before/after an update depending on how we fare.
- Export easily the result in a format that can be added to your mod.

Everything is explained in detail within the GSheet template itself, in the tab named *Guidelines*, so please read it when accessing the document, before starting to translate.

All you need to do to get started is access the [GSheet template localization file](#), which is read-only, and make your own copy. **/!\ This requires a Google account.** If you don't have one, you can still

download the file and use another method but as stated before it won't benefit from all the automatized workflow.

If you want, the GSheet that is used to make the Example Language of the Example Mod can be found [here](#). There's not much to it, but the very few entries that have been "fake-localized" can be found and provide a small display of the tracking process.

Note: The creator of a mod can translate several languages in one file or do one file by language, this doesn't really matter (but the source GSheet provided is only setup for a single language, so you have to modify it if you want to do so).

Export

Everything is explained within the template GSheet, in the **Guidelines**.

The baseline is that you need to export the file as a csv, and then change its extension to .txt before adding it to your mod.

Fonts Module

The purpose of this Module is to bring new fonts into the game. There are 2 fonts in The Last Spell, one used mostly for titles and the second being the "standard" one.

Structure

The folder needed for this Module to work must be named *Fonts* (cf section "Create the structure for your mod").

Inside of this folder will need to be the fonts (.otf and .tff extensions are supported). Those fonts can be put in subfolders, this won't change anything.

The "config.xml" file

Unlike the Localization Module, this file is **mandatory** for the Fonts Module to be valid. The purpose of this config file is to declare some FontAssemblies (1 or more). To be done, the *config.xml* file must follow this pattern:



```

1 <Config>
2   <FontAssemblies>
3     <FontAssembly id="The unique id of this FontAssembly">
4       <FontAsset path="The path to a font file" importance="The importance of this font (int)"/>
5       <FontAsset path="Louis George Cafe.ttf" importance="The importance of this font (int)"/>
6     </FontAssembly>
7   </FontAssemblies>
8   <UseFontAssemblyInModList id="The FontAssembly's id we should use to display the Description, Title and Author of this mod."/>
9 </Config>
10
11 Example :
12
13 <Config>
14   <FontAssemblies>
15     <FontAssembly id="FontAssemblyOne">
16       <FontAsset path="TitleFont.ttf" importance="0"/>
17       <FontAsset path="NormalFont.ttf" importance="1"/>
18     </FontAssembly>
19   </FontAssemblies>
20   <UseFontAssemblyInModList id="FontAssemblyOne"/>
21 </Config>

```

- **FontAssembly:** It contains FontAsset elements, up to as many fonts we have ingame (currently 2 => Titles and Standard). **Requires at least one FontAsset.**
 - **Id: Mandatory.** This id must be unique and it allows us to link this FontAssembly to one or several languages.
- **FontAsset:**
 - **Path: Mandatory.** You need to write the path to the targeted font. The path is local to the module file, which means that if the font is at its root, you just need to write the name of the font and its extension (font.ttf/otf)
 - **Importance: Mandatory.** It will allow the game to know what font to replace with this font. The available values are: 0 (Titles font) and 1 (Standard font).
- **UseFontAssemblyModList:** Allows the modder to indicate to the game it needs to use a FontAssembly to display the mod's Description, Title and Author in the ingame mod list (even before the user has selected the font in the Settings). This is especially useful when the required characters are not available in all the fonts, for example when the Fonts Module is used in conjunction with a Localization Module using specific characters like Cyrillic, Hiragana, Katakana, etc.

Important: upgrade existing mods to modding version 3

Mods that were made before version 3 (March 14th Update) need to be updated to be compatible with version 3.

The new major update causes the mod to be incompatible. This section is a tutorial on how to make your mod compatible again.

To fix this you will have to change your *config.xml* files located in the Modules folder and your *manifest.xml* file.

For the *manifest.xml* file you just have to add `<Version>3</Version>` below the Author line.

The *config.xml* files have a completely new structure; you will have to look at the ones from the *Example Mod*. Here is how to find them:

- The first thing is to make sure that you've updated/downloaded the mod named *Example Mod* created by Ishtar Games.

- Then go to your Steam Library folder and go to the folder
SteamLibrary\steamapps\workshop\content\1105670\2607059231\
- Inside the Modules folders you will find the new *config.xml* with the new structure to follow.